LEX-ARG · PRÁCTICA 02

Lenguaje para argumentar, evaluar e interactuar

Hoja 02 · Conceder y matizar

Part 1: 8 ítems (1–8) · Part 4: 6 ítems (25–30) · 20 puntos · tiempo orientativo: 25 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

Formato real del examen. En esta hoja, los huecos de la Part 1 evalúan expresiones de la teoría de LEX-ARG; en el examen se mezclan con collocations, idioms, phrasal verbs y confusables de todo tipo.

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze

For questions 1–8, read the text below and decide which answer (A, B, C or D) best fits each gap. There is an example at the beginning (0). Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Example:

0	**A** divided	**B** departed	**C** detached	**D** dispersed

The answer is **A** (divided).

Switched off

When our local secondary school banned mobile phones last year, the reaction from parents was predictably **(0)** _____. To give the head teacher her **(1)** _____, she never pretended the policy would solve everything. Her claim was a modest one: that pupils would concentrate better in lessons and talk to each other at break.

A ban is **(2)** _____ very well, critics replied, but who will enforce it? Remarkably, the pupils have largely enforced it themselves. Several of the older ones told me they were not **(3)** _____ bothered by the rule, and some admitted to feeling relieved.

The critics' deeper objection deserves a hearing, though. It is one thing to keep phones out of lessons, and quite **(4)** _____ to expect teenagers to give them up at home. A ban can work only to the **(5)** _____ that families support it, and many parents are as attached to their screens as their children are.

Too often, the debate is framed as a **(6)** _____ dichotomy: either schools embrace technology or they reject it outright. In reality, how much screen time is healthy is a matter of **(7)** _____, not of principle. **(8)** _____ any unforeseen problems, the school intends to keep the ban for at least another year, and on the evidence so far it is hard to see why it should not.

1	**A** due	**B** credit	**C** merit	**D** worth
2	**A** quite	**B** just	**C** all	**D** so
3	**A** distantly	**B** remotely	**C** faintly	**D** vaguely
4	**A** apart	**B** other	**C** different	**D** another
5	**A** length	**B** scale	**C** extent	**D** range
6	**A** false	**B** mock	**C** fake	**D** sham
7	**A** grade	**B** level	**C** measure	**D** degree
8	**A** Except	**B** Barring	**C** Unless	**D** Despite

Part 4 · Key word transformations

For questions 25–30, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. **Do not change the word given.** You must use between **three** and **eight** words, including the word given. Here is an example (0).

Example:

0 In my opinion, the plan is unworkable.

VIEW

I <u>am of the view that</u> the plan is unworkable.

The gap can be filled by the words 'am of the view that', so you write:

0 AM OF THE VIEW THAT

Write only the missing words IN CAPITAL LETTERS.

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25 You're right and I was wrong: the meeting is on Thursday, not Friday.

CORRECTED

The meeting is on Thursday, not Friday – _____.

26 The novel has some strengths, even if the ending is weak.

WITHOUT

The novel _____, even if the ending is weak.

27 Provided that nothing else changes, lower fares should bring more passengers back to the buses.

EQUAL

_____, lower fares should bring more passengers back to the buses.

28 Calling the service at the hotel disappointing would be an understatement.

MILDLY

The service at the hotel was disappointing, _____.

29 The new guidelines fail to distinguish between criticism and abuse.

DISTINCTION

The new guidelines fail _____ criticism and abuse.

30 Admittedly, the figures have improved.

CONCEDED

It _____ the figures have improved.

Hoja de respuestas · Part 1

Escribe la letra elegida (A, B, C o D). Al corregir, marca 1 punto por acierto; una respuesta doble vale 0.

Nº	Respuesta (A–D)	Punto
1		/ 1
2		/ 1
3		/ 1
4		/ 1
5		/ 1
6		/ 1
7		/ 1
8		/ 1
Total		**/ 8**

Hoja de respuestas · Part 4

Nº	Respuesta (en mayúsculas)	Puntos
25		/ 2
26		/ 2
27		/ 2
28		/ 2
29		/ 2
30		/ 2
	Total	/ 12
Total de la hoja		**/ 20**

SOLUCIONES

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze

1 punto por acierto. Cada solución explica por qué es correcta la clave y por qué falla cada distractor, y remite al apartado de LEX-ARG_Teoria_v1 (o de la teoría donde está explicado).

Nº	Clave	Expresión	Teoría
1	A · due	give sb their due	§4.1
2	C · all	(be) all very well	§4.2
3	B · remotely	not remotely	§5.3
4	D · another	it is one thing to X, quite another to Y	§4.2
5	C · extent	to the extent that	§5.1
6	A · false	a false dichotomy	§5.2
7	D · degree	a matter of degree	§5.2
8	B · Barring	barring	§5.1

1 · A due

Por qué: to give sb their due: para ser justos con alguien, reconociendo lo que merece. Concede un mérito antes de la crítica.

B credit: credit se da sin posesivo: give sb credit for sth; *give her her credit no existe.

C merit: *give sb their merit no existe.

D worth: *give sb their worth no existe; worth va en for what it's worth.

Teoría: §4.1 Conceder · Reconocer lo que vale

2 · C all

Por qué: be all very well: estar muy bien (pero…). Concede con cierta impaciencia y anuncia la objeción, que llega con but who will enforce it?

A quite: *quite very well: quite no se combina con very.

B just: *just very well no es una combinación.

D so: *so very well no forma la fórmula de concesión.

Teoría: §4.2 Conceder · Conceder y girar

3 · B remotely

Por qué: not remotely: en absoluto, ni lo más mínimo. Remotely intensifica una negación (not remotely bothered).

A distantly: distantly va con parentescos (distantly related); no intensifica negaciones.

C faintly: faintly atenúa en afirmativa (faintly ridiculous); *not faintly bothered no se usa.

D vaguely: vaguely es «ligeramente, de forma imprecisa»; *not vaguely bothered no se usa.

Teoría: §5.3 Matizar · Graduar la certeza

4 • D another

Por qué: It is one thing to X, and quite another to Y: una cosa es X y otra muy distinta Y. One thing pide another.

A apart: apart no forma la estructura; quite apart from es «aparte de».

B other: other necesita un sustantivo o va en plural; *quite other to expect no es posible.

C different: different exigiría quite a different thing; solo no completa la estructura.

Teoría: §4.2 Conceder · Conceder y girar

5 • C extent

Por qué: to the extent that: en la medida en que. Limita la afirmación a una condición: el apoyo de las familias.

A length: length forma go to great lengths o at length, no *to the length that.

B scale: *to the scale that no existe; on a … scale es otra estructura.

D range: *to the range that no existe.

Teoría: §5.1 Matizar · Limitar el alcance

6 • A false

Por qué: a false dichotomy: una falsa disyuntiva. Lo explica lo que sigue: either … or … presenta como únicas dos opciones que no lo son.

B mock: mock es «simulado» (a mock exam); no forma *mock dichotomy.

C fake: fake se dice de objetos falsificados (a fake passport); no de un razonamiento.

D sham: sham es «farsa, montaje» (a sham marriage); no forma *sham dichotomy.

Teoría: §5.2 Matizar · Distinguir y redefinir

7 • D degree

Por qué: a matter of degree: una cuestión de grado, no de naturaleza. El contraste con not of principle lo confirma.

A grade: *a matter of grade no existe.

B level: *a matter of level no existe.

C measure: *a matter of measure no existe; measure va en by any measure.

Teoría: §5.2 Matizar · Distinguir y redefinir

8 • B Barring

Por qué: Barring + sustantivo: salvo que haya, a menos que surja (barring any unforeseen problems).

A Except: except necesitaría for y significa «excepto», no «salvo que surja».

C Unless: unless es conjunción: pide una oración (unless there are problems), no un sustantivo.

D Despite: despite concede un hecho conocido; con any unforeseen problems, que son hipotéticos, no encaja: el sentido es «si no surge ningún problema».

Teoría: §5.1 Matizar · Limitar el alcance

Part 4 · Key word transformations

Corrige cada ítem por mitades: 1 punto por cada mitad correcta y bien escrita. Se acepta cualquiera de las variantes indicadas; las respuestas fuera de 3–8 palabras o con la palabra clave cambiada valen 0.

25 I STAND CORRECTED (3 palabras)

También vale: [AND] I STAND CORRECTED [ON THAT / THERE] (3–6) · **(YOU'RE RIGHT / YOU ARE RIGHT) [AND] I STAND CORRECTED** (6–7) · **I WAS WRONG AND [I] STAND CORRECTED** (6–7)

Mitades: I stand | corrected

Por qué: I stand corrected: rectifico, tienes razón. Es la fórmula fija para aceptar una corrección.

No puntúa: *I AM CORRECTED (no es la fórmula: el verbo es stand); *YOU STAND CORRECTED (la fórmula es en primera persona: la dice quien se equivocó).

Teoría: §4.3 Conceder · En la conversación

26 IS NOT WITHOUT MERIT (4 palabras)

También vale: (IS NOT / ISN'T) [ENTIRELY / ALTOGETHER / COMPLETELY] WITHOUT (MERIT / ITS MERITS / SOME MERIT / ITS STRENGTHS / STRENGTHS / SOME STRENGTHS / ITS VIRTUES / ITS GOOD POINTS / SOME GOOD POINTS / ITS REDEEMING FEATURES / REDEEMING FEATURES / ITS MOMENTS) (4–7) · **IS BY NO MEANS WITHOUT (MERIT / ITS MERITS / ITS STRENGTHS)** (6–7)

Mitades: is not without | merit

Por qué: Not without merit: litotes que concede algún mérito, sin entusiasmo. Equivale a has some strengths.

No puntúa: *IS WITHOUT MERIT (sin not dice lo contrario); *IS NOT LACKING IN MERIT (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0).

Teoría: §4.1 Conceder · Reconocer lo que vale · RDG-P5 §4.3 Ironía, understatement y concesión

27 ALL THINGS BEING EQUAL (4 palabras)

También vale: ALL [OTHER] THINGS BEING EQUAL (4–5) · **OTHER THINGS BEING EQUAL** (4) · **(ALL ELSE / EVERYTHING ELSE) BEING EQUAL** (4) · **(IF / PROVIDED / PROVIDING / PROVIDED THAT / PROVIDING THAT / ASSUMING / AS LONG AS) ALL [OTHER] THINGS ARE EQUAL** (5–8) · **(IF / PROVIDED / PROVIDING / PROVIDED THAT / PROVIDING THAT / ASSUMING / AS LONG AS) (ALL ELSE / EVERYTHING ELSE) (IS / REMAINS) EQUAL** (5–7)

Mitades: all (other) things | being equal

Por qué: All (other) things being equal: en igualdad de condiciones, si nada más cambia. Recoge provided that nothing else changes. También valen all else being equal y las versiones con if / provided + are equal.

No puntúa: *ALL THINGS ARE EQUAL (la fórmula es absoluta, con being); *PROVIDED NOTHING ELSE CHANGES (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0).

Teoría: §5.1 Matizar · Limitar el alcance

28 TO PUT IT MILDLY (4 palabras)

También vale: TO PUT IT [VERY / RATHER] MILDLY (4–5) · **PUTTING IT MILDLY** (3) · **(AND / THOUGH / ALTHOUGH / BUT) (THAT'S / THAT IS) PUTTING IT [VERY] MILDLY** (6–7) · **WHICH IS PUTTING IT [VERY] MILDLY** (5–6)

Mitades: to put it | mildly

Por qué: To put it mildly: por decirlo suavemente; avisa de que lo dicho se queda corto, igual que would be an understatement.

No puntúa: *TO SAY IT MILDLY (el verbo es put); *TO PUT IT IN A MILD WAY (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0).

Teoría: §5.3 Matizar · Graduar la certeza · UOE-P4 §7 Tabla de referencia por palabra clave

29 TO DRAW A DISTINCTION BETWEEN (5 palabras)

También vale: TO (DRAW / MAKE / ESTABLISH) (A / ANY / THE) [CLEAR] DISTINCTION BETWEEN (5–6)

Mitades: to draw a distinction | between

Por qué: Draw / make a distinction between: distinguir entre dos cosas. El verbo y between son fijos.

No puntúa: *TO DRAW A DISTINCTION OF (la preposición es between); *TO DO A DISTINCTION BETWEEN (el verbo es draw o make).

Teoría: §5.2 Matizar · Distinguir y redefinir

30 MUST BE CONCEDED THAT (4 palabras)

También vale: (MUST / HAS TO / SHOULD / NEEDS TO) BE CONCEDED THAT (4–5)

Mitades: must be conceded | that

Por qué: It must be conceded that: hay que reconocer que. Es la versión impersonal y formal de admittedly.

No puntúa: *IS CONCEDED THAT (dice que alguien lo concede, no que haya que reconocerlo); *MUST BE CONCEDED (falta that para enlazar con la oración).

Teoría: §4.1 Conceder · Reconocer lo que vale